



Tutorial Letter 002/1/2026

Academic Language and Literacy in English

ENG1503

Assignment 02

Semester 1

Department of English Studies

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

This tutorial letter contains important information about the
ENG1503 Assignment 02 for Semester 1

Note: This is a fully online module. This document is,
therefore, only available on myUnisa.

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Dear student,

This section of the tutorial letter serves to guide you in the writing of the second assignment included below. Our intention is to unpack and explain the assignment question in such a manner that you are able to use these guidelines meaningfully to select the appropriate structures and content for the assignment. By now, you should have downloaded the Tutorial Letter 101 under the “Official study material” from the main ENG1503-26-S1 on Moodle LMS site to check the assignment due dates and weightings.

It is important that your assignment is presented in a formal way. As there is no official cover page, please make sure that your cover page contains the following information: your full names and surname, unique number, module name/code and assignment number. Handwritten assignments are not allowed in this module. Use Arial font style, 12 point, and 1.5 spacing when typing your assignments.

Do not forget to attach a signed declaration form to your assignment because it is mandatory/compulsory to include it. The declaration form can be found at the back page of the Tutorial Letter 101 or under the Additional Resources tab. If you do not have access to a scanner, you may retype the declaration form and insert an electronic signature/ type your name and surname in the signature line. You are only able to upload 1 file in your assignment submission link. Your declaration needs to be incorporated into your assignment file as one document.

Your assignment should be saved as a ‘pdf’ document. Please make sure you are submitting/ have submitted the correct document to avoid being awarded a ‘0’ mark. In your answers, we expect evidence of, inter alia, critical reading, skimming, and scanning skills, comprehension, reflexive response, coherence and cohesion, grammaticality, paragraphing, and correct spelling. In general, your paragraphs should be properly structured and coherent. The paragraphs should demonstrate excellent use of grammar, vocabulary, and be properly edited as well as proof-read.

During the course of the semester, we will be posting feedback on assignments. You are advised to frequently visit the Moodle LMS site for the module ENG1503 on myUnisa and interact with your lecturers for more guidance.

NB: A significant and helpful source that will guide you successfully as you answer this assignment is the “ASSIGNMENT 02 PODCAST and VODCAST” and the “ASSIGNMENT 02 FEEDFORWARD TUTORIAL LETTER” that will be prepared by your lecturers and uploaded under myUnisa’s “Assignment 02 resources”. Please download the RESOURCES when uploaded, listen, and read them attentively/carefully, and follow the presented instructions as you answer this assignment. Please attend the Microsoft Teams LIVESTREAM SESSION for Assignment 02 that will be scheduled. You will receive the Microsoft Teams meeting link via the announcements on the main ENG1503 site. If you are unable to attend the

livestreaming session, a recording link will be posted on the main ENG1503 site so that you will be able to watch the presentation at your own time. Please keep checking the announcements we post on a regular basis. Please do NOT ignore email notifications on your mylife email account.

Reading strategies

There are many academic reading strategies. For this second assignment, we describe four basic reading strategies you need to develop for successful and meaningful reading of a text. You should be able to use the following techniques:

- Summarising: Identifying, outlining, and making notes of main points or ideas presented in the text (see page 66 and 67 of your study guide)
- Paraphrasing: Expressing the author's ideas in your own words.
- Questioning: Asking yourself questions as you read, e.g. What is the main idea of this paragraph? The questions should be formulated and expressed in your own words.
- Synthesis: A synthesis is a written discussion (combination of ideas) that draws on two or more sources.

Paragraph writing

Consult your Study Guide on pages 36-39 for more information on writing paragraphs. Your prescribed textbook also has detailed material on writing paragraphs (Gaetz et al., 2018: 83- 88). Please study these texts and the examples given. A paragraph should have:

- A topic sentence: which introduces the idea of the paragraph.
- A supporting sentence: which explains or gives examples/quotations which support the main idea contained in the topic sentence; and,

NB: Please note that a paragraph should NOT be numbered or include bullet points.

Assignment: 02 Compulsory: Yes

Opened: Tuesday, 17 March 2026, 8:00 AM

Due: Wednesday, 15 April 2026, 11:00 PM

Unique number: 185210

Research-based essay Instructions:

In this assignment, you are expected to write an academic essay of 500 words. Your essay should demonstrate the conventions you have learned from the module regarding essay structure and layout. This includes formulating a thesis statement, ensuring clarity of message, taking a stance, using appropriate academic vocabulary for the type of essay, maintaining cohesion and logical organisation of information, applying proper paragraphing, using correct sentence structure, and referencing accurately

Your essay will be assessed using an assessment rubric provided at the end of this document. Before submitting your assignment, please consult the rubric in this document to make sure that you have addressed all the aspects in the assessment criteria.

N.B.: Refer to the three PDF articles embedded in this document to support your responses. You are ONLY permitted to use in-text citations from the provided sources to support your arguments. DO NOT refer to any external sources not listed or cited below. To avoid failing this assignment, DO NOT copy directly from these sources, but rather paraphrase any information that you have borrowed from the sources and acknowledge them accordingly. Apply the knowledge you have been taught on proper acknowledgement of sources, academic integrity and avoiding plagiarism.

Read the extract below and answer the question that follows:

South Africa's constitution has 11 official languages, and it promotes the development of the Khoi, Nama, and San languages, as well as sign language (The South African Constitution, 2012). HEIs have to develop institutional language policies that are informed by the language policy framework for public higher education institutions, as determined in terms of Section 27(2) of the Higher Education Act, 101 of 1997 (as amended) (DHET, 2020) and by the South African Constitution. This language policy framework encourages multilingualism and the development of African languages to become LoLTs alongside English and Afrikaans. It states that: Language continues to be a barrier to access and success for many students at South African higher education institutions. Despite their status as official languages, indigenous languages have in the past and at present, structurally not been afforded the official space to function as academic and scientific languages ... The persistent underdevelopment and undervaluing of indigenous languages should not be allowed if public higher education institutions are to meet the diverse linguistic needs of their student population. Conditions must therefore, be created for the development and strengthening of indigenous languages as languages of meaningful academic discourse, as well as sources of knowledge in the different disciplines of higher education. (p. 9)

Source: Ndlangamandla, S.C. & Chaka, C., 2023. Relocating English Studies and SoTL in the Global South: Towards Decolonizing English and Critiquing the Coloniality of Language. University of South Africa. See earlier comments

Using the extract above as a point of reference, do you think multilingualism should be adopted as an approach to teaching, learning, and assessment in countries that are linguistically diverse? Think of a country that has a diverse linguistic background and read the articles listed below. Based on the sources provided above and the content of the articles, write an argumentative essay in which you take a clear stance either agreeing or disagreeing with the statement. In your essay, provide three wellsupported arguments or solutions to justify your position.

Before you begin your argumentative essay, follow the instructions below carefully:

1. Read the three articles carefully and use the information you have found to support your stance in your argumentative essay.
2. Plan your writing by mind-mapping your identified ideas. DO NOT submit your mindmap.
3. Remember to only cite from the THREE sources included in this document.
4. To access the full text articles, click on the links below:

Link 1: <https://doi.org/10.33394/jolt.v%vi%i.7158>

Link 2: <https://doi.org/10.56285/jltVol57iss1a5273>

Link 3: <https://doi.org/10.56285/jltVol57iss2a5836>

We will use the marking rubric on the next page to assess your essay.

Level	Range	Content	Language	Presentation and writing conventions.	Overall comment
1		40	40	20	
1	0-5	• Very little or no evidence of understanding and knowledge of the topic. • Very little understanding of the genre conventions • Fragmented/disjointed/ muddled ideas • Writer stance and voice muddled	• Poor command of vocabulary, sentence structure and punctuation • Very limited use of the appropriate grammar and syntactic structures • Inappropriate use of expressions	• Cluttered presentation. • Illegible handwriting. • Many grammatical and typographical errors, which impede meaning. • Poor knowledge of genre conventions	Very Poor
2	6-9	• Unsatisfactory handling of the topic • Some irrelevant and repeated information • Mundane handling of the topic • Flawed by generalizations and inadequate supporting detail • Writer stance and voice vague and indeterminate	• Limited vocabulary and sentence variety • Inadequate use of appropriate syntactic language features/structures • Poor punctuation and sentence construction • Obscured/confused meaning	Marks 0 – 2 Inconsistently defined paragraphs Progression of ideas hard to follow. Essay introduction and conclusion not clearly defined. A few gaps in knowledge of genre. Marks 3-4	Poor
3	10-12	• Some understanding and knowledge of the topic • Reasonable development of idea inadequate appraisal of positions on the topic. • A few lapses in content, claims not fully supported • Sometimes disjointed and loosely presented ideas • Inadequate/incomplete sequencing of ideas • Writer stance and voice hardly discernible	• Occasional flawed sentences, punctuation and spelling errors • Word choice, vocabulary and diction is appropriate for the genre • Sentence structures are correct but not as varied • Sentences are not so well linked and coherent	• Reasonably good presentation • A few poorly structured paragraphs • Legible, but with some typing errors. • Clearly defined introduction and conclusion.	Satisfactory - Good
4	13-16	• Sound understanding and knowledge of the topic • Convincing but not captivating presentation of the topic • A concerted effort at originality • Relevant supporting details • Evidence of a research based argument but not well substantiated • Writer stance and voice but with some hesitation	• Very good command of grammatical structures • A wide range of vocabulary, linking devices and sentence structures • Demonstrates a mastery of the register of the genre • Sentence are linked, and coherent • Meaning clear, occasionally hindered by grammatical errors	• Well-structured essay, neat and legible • Clearly defined paragraphs • Clearly defined introduction and conclusion. • Structure is easy to follow and adheres to the structure of the genre. Marks 5-6	Good-very good
5	17-20	• An excellent understanding and knowledge of the topic. • Well-conducted appraisal of positions on the topic • Insightful and original demonstrating a clear stance and voice • Highly selective supporting details • Captivating introduction and highly convincing	• Punctuation and grammar are correct • Word choice, vocabulary and diction is highly appropriate for the genre • Demonstrates a mastery of the register of the genre • Sentence structure is correct and varied • Sentence are linked, coherent • Meaning clear with very few or no grammar errors	• Logical flow of ideas in the essay and within paragraphs. • Very clear introduction and conclusion • Structure is easy to follow and adheres to the structure of the genre Marks 9-10	Excellent-outstanding

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